

Shrubs preferring wall protection

Walls can provide favorable growing conditions for shrubs, especially evergreens, that are only moderately frost hardy. Some winter-flowering shrubs also bloom more reliably and freely when given wall protection. The best wall-side situations are warm and sunny, and provide good shelter from cold winds in winter and early spring. The warmth from heat loss through house walls, and the well-drained conditions near the base of walls, also assist the survival of slightly tender shrubs that do not like damp soil.

SHRUBS

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Leptospermum scoparium 'Red Damask'



Melianthus major

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TENDER AND EXOTIC PLANTS Shrubs

Brunfelsia pauciflora
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Tibouchina urvilleana, p.457



Garrya elliptica



Abutilon megapotanicum

Plants for paving and wall crevices

In mountainous regions, many alpine plants grow in deep cracks and crevices in the rock. Some are clump-forming or trailing in habit; others, such as saxifrages and sempervivums, grow as rosettes extending by means of runners. If laying paving, leave crevices for small plants, but restrict planting to little-used areas where they can survive. When building stone retaining walls, tilt slabs slightly backward to create deep pockets, and plant them up as the wall is being constructed. Most wall plants thrive in sunny situations, but ramondas and most small ferns prefer moist shade.



PERENNIALS

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Ourisia coccinea, p.269

Grasses and bamboos

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Ferns

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ROCK PLANTS

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Aurinia saxatilis and cvs, p.335
Campanula cochlearifolia, p.369

ABOVE Adorning walls with color

Spreading geraniums, ferns, and small, clump-forming plants can add color and texture to walls and paving.

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Phlox douglasii 'Crackerjack', p.365
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